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Project #018: Pre-Risk Stratification Plan

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Early-Risk Stratification Improve Patient Outcomes Through Team Education

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Abstract

Our goal was to provide hospital staff with the resources and tools to help identify clinical signs of a change in patient status. Direct communication between our Physician Champion and staff to broke down any hierarchical barriers, allowing all team members to communicate critical information in a protected space.

Our Physician Champion provided engaging lectures and team discussions to our staff, educating them on clear and unambiguous roles, which ultimately improved our patients chances of survival.

Plan / Introduction

Problem Description: Hospital Staff, specifically our Rapid Response Team, were feeling overwhelmed with code blue calls and delayed identification of critical patients. This situation did not allow time to properly debrief with attending physicians.

Available Knowledge: HFWH 360 bed acute care hospital. Home to 26 bed ICU and 73 bed Emergency Department. In 2024 there were 66 Code Blue Calls and 3510 Rapid Response calls.

Rationale:Our front line staff are an essential point of contact with the patient. Ensuring they have the necessary education and support, will help them recognize critical, patient decline and increase the patients chances of survival.

Specific Aim(s)/Goal(s): Decrease the number of Code Blue Calls by 10% in 8 months and provide our patients with educated, competent staff providing safe and efficient care.

Do / Methods

Intervention(s): Quality RN Met with Physician Champion to launch one on one meetings; focusing on key hospital domains: ED, Rapid Response Team, Cardiovascular, Electro Physiology, General Medical floors and ICU. Over 12 hours of recorded educational sessions.

Study of the Intervention(s): To educate the staff: Microsoft Teams platform was utilized to capture and record in-depth conversations between staff and Physician Champion. This was achieved through direct and candid question and answer format covering topics such as unusual heat rhythms, brainstorming streamlining processes.

Community Involvement: In April a community oriented Heart Healthy Symposium was organized. CardioVascular Team members transformed the Large Conference Rooms into a Cardiovascular Triage Center and with the help of 5 Cardiologists and 18 Staff Members, we were able to educate over 160 community members on healthy vital signs, blood sugar and diet practices and they also received a free Consult from a Cardiologist.

Check / Results

Our team identified the number of rapid responses and Code Blue alerts from January 2024 through August 2024 (pre-intervention) and January 2025 through August 2025 (post-intervention).

After reviewing the data tables we found that Hospital Codes reduced by 30%

While we originally set a goal of decreasing Rapid Response calls by 10% , we quickly realized that, due to early staff detection, of patient decline, rapid response calls should not be expected to decrease since they are preventing Code Blue incidents.

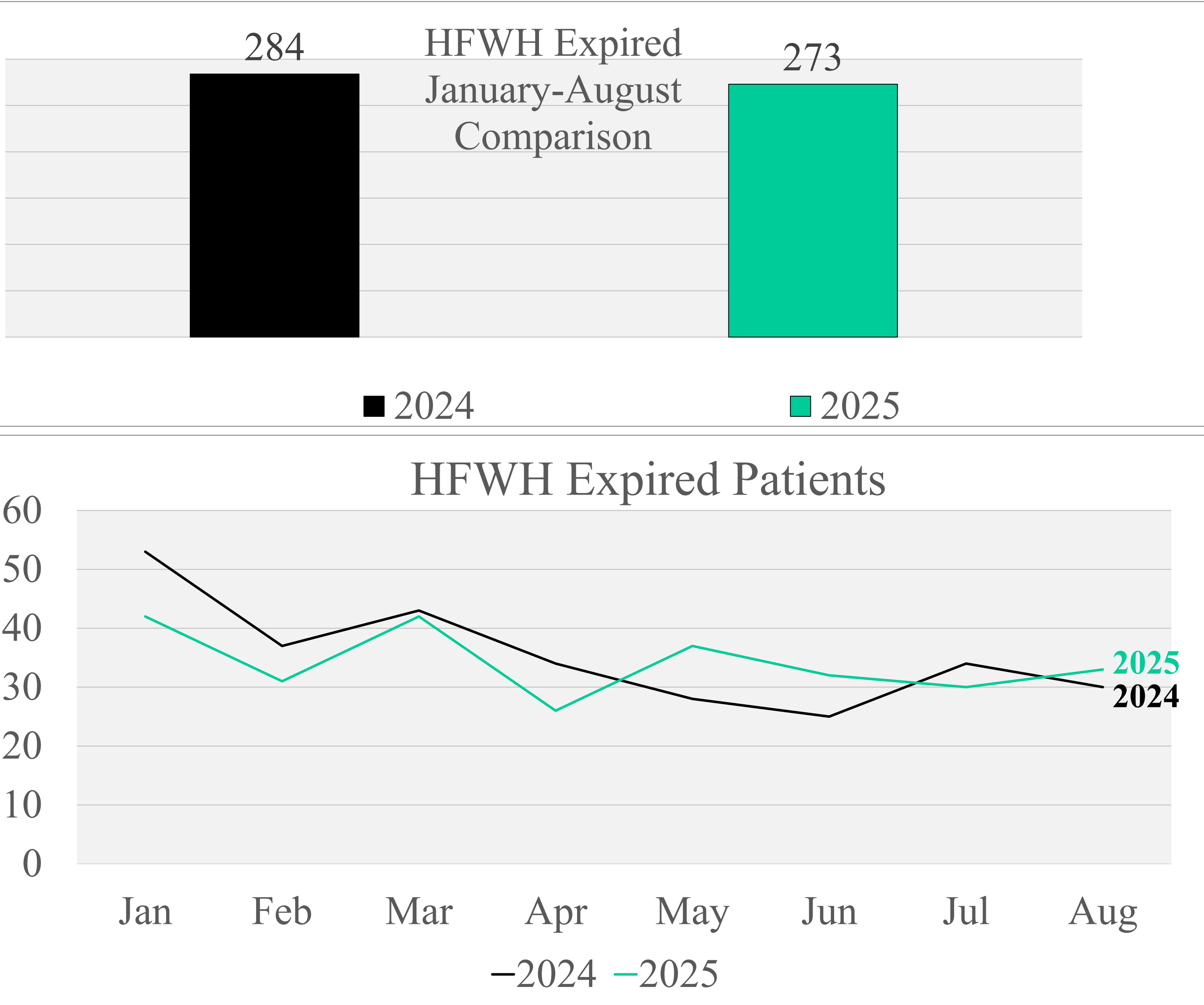
Act / Discussion

Summary:Safe-space education and discussion with our Physician Champion boosted confidence and empowered our clinical staff to provide optimal care to critical patients. By identifying critical patients earlier through focused staff education, we are able to reduce code blue alerts and increase patient survival.

Limitations: Staff education with our Cardiologist was limited in scope and time. All staff were not able to be present. Virtual Platform recording feature added to allow for all members as well as, new staff, to access.

Conclusions: Improving Team focused education and discussions with specialists help clinical staff identify and manage critical patients early, reducing patient deterioration.

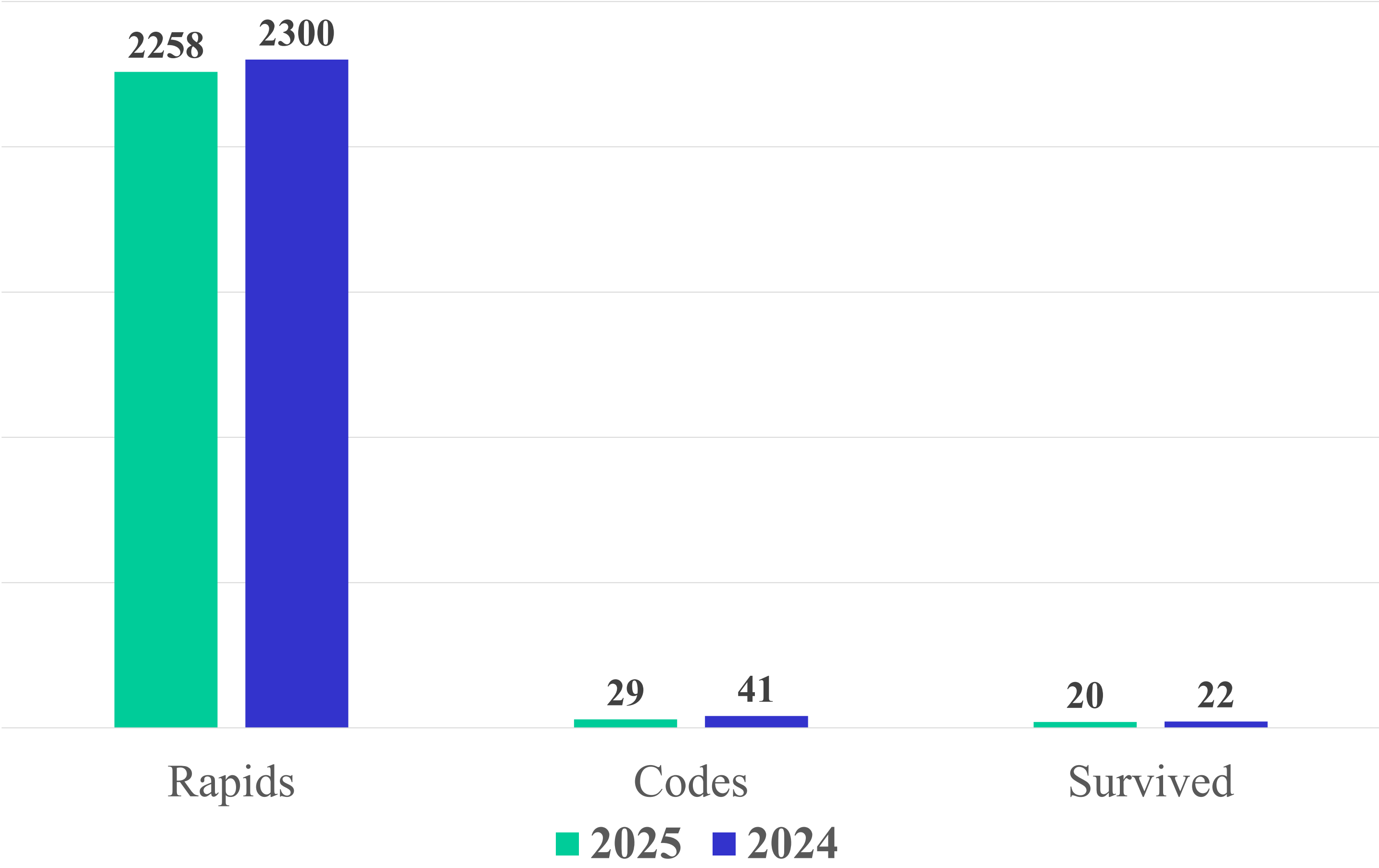
Tables



Figures



Code Survival Rates



References

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